

# From fax machines to AI

Medi Assist bets big on transforming Indian healthcare sector

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**N**ot too long ago, if you tried to file a health insurance claim in India, there was a decent chance your hospital was sending discharge bills through a fax machine at best or physical copies at worst. Not exactly the image you'd expect from a country marching steadily into a digital future. Enter Medi Assist, an unlikely hero in an industry plagued by archaic processes. By combining AI with digitisation, and a singular focus on user experience, this company has quietly started to reshape India's healthcare insurance sector unbeknownst to most of us.

Once burdened by manual processes and outdated technologies, India's healthcare insurance ecosystem is now poised for a radical transformation. And Medi Assist, a once-ordinary Third Party Administrator (TPA), is one of the few companies aspiring to disrupt the status quo.

## Indian healthcare system is ready for reinvention

India's health insurance ecosystem is notoriously fragmented. Think of it as a giant labyrinth with multiple insurers,

thousands of hospitals, each with different forms, disclaimers, and haphazard record-keeping. "The biggest challenge in Indian healthcare is that there are no common standard data formats anywhere in the country," Satish laments. "The hospital policies are written in Word documents... lots of conditions, lots of policy language that needs interpretation."

In simpler terms, it's a data nightmare that can overwhelm the best of us.

Hospital records? Could be an Excel

sheet, a scribbled note, or a typed-out PDF. Policy

documents? Possibly a 10-page Word

document with complicated

clauses and sub-clauses only

a lawyer could understand. If

you've ever filed a claim, you know how

that chaos can chew up

time, money, and sanity – all of which are in short supply

during a medical emergency. Medi Assist wants to

tackle this bottleneck head-on. Over the last four years, they poured resources into proprietary digitisation methods, scanning and standardising millions of bills. "We use a fair bit of machine learning models today to detect fraud and, you know, prevent those shady claims from getting paid," Satish explains.



**Satish Gidugu**  
CEO Medi Assist

The Medi Assist tech stack, however, is about more than just scanning documents – it's about creating a rules-based algorithmic engine that can interpret unstructured policy text, check it against the scanned hospital data, and instantly figure out which charges are valid and which are suspicious.

## AI for fraud detection in hospital claims

The real magic, as you might guess, comes from artificial intelligence. Dhruv Rastogi, the Senior Vice President & Head of Data Science at Medi Assist, came aboard with experience spanning Vodafone, Reliance, and Nomura. "I have been working in data science, AI data-plot platforms for quite a while now," he says. "I initiated scaled data science teams and drove a lot of growth and digital transformations for organizations leveraging AI and data."

At Medi Assist, Dhruv's AI capabilities power some of the most cutting-edge solutions in the insurance TPA landscape, of which fraud detection is a big chunk. Historically, detecting a suspicious claim was a tedious manual process – someone might glance at a weirdly high invoice or notice that the same hospital bill came in for two different patients. But those manual processes catch only the obvious red flags, not the more subtle and ingenious fraud manifestations.

And the result speaks for itself, according to Satish. "The savings that we're delivering on account of frauds to insurers from February 2024 till now, over the last 6 months, have doubled. This is simply because we're able to bring over 160 parameters from all the data sources, find models and correlations that humans just can't find," Satish emphasises, underscoring just how much the proprietary AI engine developed by Medi Assist is accelerating the delivery of value to the healthcare ecosystem.

## Building a tech platform that enhances transparency

Amid all this talk of invoice scanning and AI, Satish highlights another critical